ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Advanced relative clauses

Use non-defining clauses, preposition plus whom or which, whose and quantifier relatives to add precise information. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use advanced relative clauses to attach essential or supplementary information while keeping reference and punctuation clear while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Use non-defining clauses, preposition plus whom or which, whose and quantifier relatives to add precise information.

MODEL

The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

noun, relative clause, | preposition + whom/which | quantifier + of whom/which

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main advanced relative clauses patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses attach essential or supplementary information while keeping reference and punctuation clear.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in formal description, profiles, reports and academic explanation.

Build meaning before form

Use non-defining clauses, preposition plus whom or which, whose and quantifier relatives to add precise information.

What advanced relative clauses communicates

Use non-defining clauses, preposition plus whom or which, whose and quantifier relatives to add precise information.

The central purpose is to attach essential or supplementary information while keeping reference and punctuation clear. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.	extra information that does not identify the noun
The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.	a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted
The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.	a quantified subset of people or things already identified

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: noun, relative clause, | preposition + whom/which | quantifier + of whom/which. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Supplementary clause	noun, who/which + clause,	The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.
Formal preposition	preposition + whom/which	The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.
Quantifier relative	some/most/none + of whom/which	The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
extra information that does not identify the noun	Supplementary clause
a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted	Formal preposition
a quantified subset of people or things already identified	Quantifier relative

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in formal description, profiles, reports and academic explanation. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04	05
noun, relative clause,	preposition	whom/which	quantifier	of whom/which

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: attach essential or supplementary information while keeping reference and punctuation clear.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits formal description, profiles, reports and academic explanation.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Supplementary clause	noun, who/which + clause,	The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.
Formal preposition	preposition + whom/which	The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.
Quantifier relative	some/most/none + of whom/which	The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.	extra information that does not identify the noun
The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.	a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted
The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.	a quantified subset of people or things already identified

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit commas around a non-defining relative clause.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use that immediately after a fronted preposition.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use of that in a quantifier relative.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: extra information that does not identify the noun?

OPTIONS The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review. · The committee to which she reported has been dissolved. · The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted?

OPTIONS The committee to which she reported has been dissolved. · The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision. · The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a quantified subset of people or things already identified?

OPTIONS The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision. · The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review. · The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS extra information that does not identify the noun · a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted · a quantified subset of people or things already identified

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted · a quantified subset of people or things already identified · extra information that does not identify the noun

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a quantified subset of people or things already identified · extra information that does not identify the noun · a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Supplementary clause / Formal preposition / Quantifier relative · Gap 2: extra information that does not identify the noun / a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted / a quantified subset of people or things already identified

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"The committee to which she reported has been dissolved." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Formal preposition / Quantifier relative / Supplementary clause · Gap 2: a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted / a quantified subset of people or things already identified / extra information that does not identify the noun

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Quantifier relative / Supplementary clause / Formal preposition · Gap 2: a quantified subset of people or things already identified / extra information that does not identify the noun / a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses extra information that does not identify the noun: _____. Choose the model that expresses a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted: _____. Choose the model that expresses a quantified subset of people or things already identified: _____. Choose the model built with noun, who/which + clause,: _____. Choose the model built with preposition + whom/which: _____. Choose the model built with some/most/none + of whom/which: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The committee to which she reported has been dissolved. · The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review. · The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The new director, _____, will lead the review. The committee _____ she reported has been dissolved. The proposal, several _____ remain unclear, needs revision. State the full structural pattern for Supplementary clause: _____. State the full structural pattern for Formal preposition: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The new director will lead the review; she joined in May.” using the Supplementary clause pattern to express extra information that does not identify the noun.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “She reported to the committee, and it has been dissolved.” using the Formal preposition pattern to express a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Several parts of the proposal remain unclear.” using the Quantifier relative pattern to express a quantified subset of people or things already identified.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The new director will lead the review; she joined in May.” using the Supplementary clause pattern to express extra information that does not identify the noun.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Supplementary clause to express extra information that does not identify the noun, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Formal preposition to express a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Quantifier relative to express a quantified subset of people or things already identified, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.

Supplementary clause is the best match because extra information that does not identify the noun.

A2

The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.

Formal preposition is the best match because a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted.

A3

The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

Quantifier relative is the best match because a quantified subset of people or things already identified.

A4

extra information that does not identify the noun

The Supplementary clause pattern communicates extra information that does not identify the noun.

A5

a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted

The Formal preposition pattern communicates a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted.

A6

a quantified subset of people or things already identified

The Quantifier relative pattern communicates a quantified subset of people or things already identified.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Supplementary clause / extra information that does not identify the noun

The structure belongs to the Supplementary clause pattern. Its communicative purpose is extra information that does not identify the noun.

B2

Formal preposition / a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted

The structure belongs to the Formal preposition pattern. Its communicative purpose is a formal relative relationship with the preposition fronted.

B3

Quantifier relative / a quantified subset of people or things already identified

The structure belongs to the Quantifier relative pattern. Its communicative purpose is a quantified subset of people or things already identified.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.

Supplementary clause: noun, who/which + clause,.

C2

The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.

Formal preposition: preposition + whom/which.

C3

The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

Quantifier relative: some/most/none + of whom/which.

C4

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.

Supplementary clause: noun, who/which + clause,.

C5

The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.

Formal preposition: preposition + whom/which.

C6

The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

Quantifier relative: some/most/none + of whom/which.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

who joined in May

Supplementary clause requires “who joined in May” in this model. noun, who/which + clause,.

D2

to which

Formal preposition requires “to which” in this model. preposition + whom/which.

D3

parts of which

Quantifier relative requires “parts of which” in this model. some/most/none + of whom/which.

D4

noun, who/which + clause,

Supplementary clause is built as noun, who/which + clause,.

D5

preposition + whom/which

Formal preposition is built as preposition + whom/which.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.

noun, who/which + clause,. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended supplementary clause effect.

E2

The committee to which she reported has been dissolved.

preposition + whom/which. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended formal preposition effect.

E3

The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision.

some/most/none + of whom/which. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended quantifier relative effect.

E4

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review.

noun, who/which + clause,. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended supplementary clause effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The new director, who joined in May, will lead the review. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses noun, who/which + clause, accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The committee to which she reported has been dissolved. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses preposition + whom/which accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The proposal, several parts of which remain unclear, needs revision. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses some/most/none + of whom/which accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____